

Fig 10.6 Different shapes of kidney stones

the body. The device used for this procedure is called a Lithotripter. Kidney stones can also be removed surgically. A percutaneous nephrolithotomy is a procedure in which a kidney stone is removed via a small incision in the skin. A kidney stone may also be removed with a ureteroscope, an instrument that is advanced up through the urethra and bladder to the ureter.

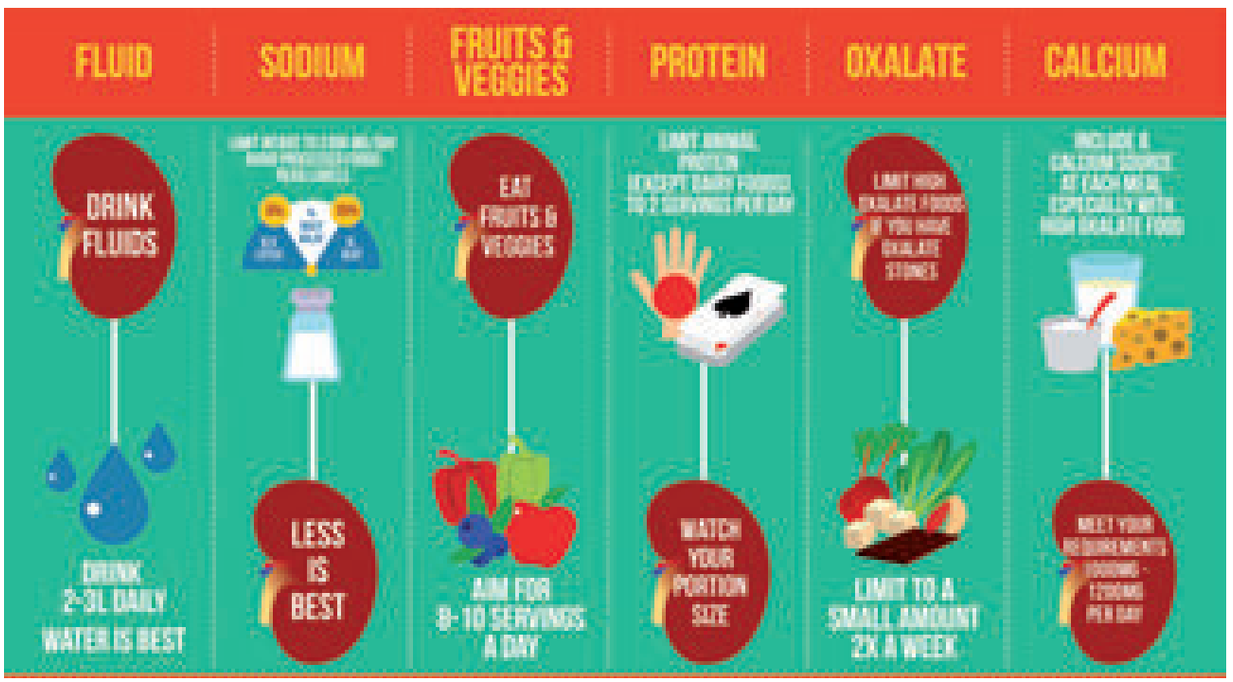
10.4.5.Dietary management

Fluids: Stone formation is a gradual process, and the tendency in a susceptible person persists throughout life. Vigilance with adequate fluid intake and diet is needed indefinitely.

The fundamental principle in the treatment of kidney stones is to supply adequate fluids like water, coconut water, barley water, fruit juices and weak tea in order to ensure the passage of over 2000ml of urine per day. A heavy manual worker in a hot humid climate should drink more fluids than a sedentary office worker in a cooler climate to compensate for fluid loss through perspiration. The simplest guide is to drink enough fluids to see that the urine is very light in colour.

Dilute urine avoids concentration of solids and also tends to make the urine neutral, thus preventing the acid or alkaline reaction which predisposes to precipitation of crystals.

Foods: Although the role of diet in the formation of urinary stones is not well established, it is advisable to restrict foods that are rich in calcium, oxalate or uric acid according to the type of stone formed. The following table gives the list of foods that are rich in calcium, oxalate or uric acid.



Unit 10 Diet in kidney diseases Final 12-12-2018.indd 168 25-02-2019 15:37:58